revolutionary victory, reported that "every man present expressed individually and emphatically, the view that it would be in the interest of the United States and of American business in Cuba for the United States to recognize the provisional government as quickly as possible … They considered that prompt recognition was necessary to establish the most favorable possible climate in which to carry on business."[3] The following day this advice was carried out, and the United States recognized the revolutionary government.

One of the reasons that U.S. businesses had argued for recognition of Castro, and that the U.S. government went along, was that they could not ignore the overwhelming popular mobilization behind the Revolution. U.S. officials, the Ambassador explained, "had no enthusiasm for Castro, only a determination to be in the best possible position to deal effectively on behalf of American interests with the new ruler whose people appeared united in idolizing him."[4]

The task, then, was to try to guide – or manipulate – the new government into compliance with U.S. business and economic development goals. This could be accomplished, in part, by "strengthening the moderating and stabilizing influences on Castro and the Cuban government."[5] In addition, the United States should "seek to isolate and reduce the influence of the 'radical' element of the 26th of July forces and the Communists" by "maneuvering them into positions where they will be seen to be undercutting Castro's programs."[6]

On May 8th, 1959, Castro made an important statement of the Revolution's goals and policies, in implicit response to U.S. accusations of Communist influence in Cuba. The U.S. Ambassador described a crowd of 600,000 who gathered to hear his speech as overcome with "nearly hysterical adulation" and noted that "this is one man rule with full approval of 'masses.' " The Ambassador summarized Castro's stance: "Revolution neither capitalist, Communist, nor center, but rather step in advance of all. Said current world conflict was between concept which offered people democracy and starved them to death, and concept which offered food but suppressed liberties. Cuban solution was to promote all rights of mankind, including 'social rights.' Only ideas